

Techademy Presents: Leading the Way in L&D

Building the Foundation

Srilata's career has been marked by deliberate choices. Starting from financial services and healthcare to roles in IT/ITES and BPO, she sought opportunities that help understand people and processes deeply. "I dedicate 10% of my salary to a recurring deposit for personal development and upskilling," she says, underscoring her belief in the power of continuous self-improvement. These experiences shaped her belief that continuous upskilling is the key to navigating any challenge.

Leadership at CGI

Joining CGI in the Asia Pacific marked a pivotal chapter in Srilata's career trajectory. Here, she found an environment that mirrored her values—trust, collaboration, and a relentless focus on innovation. She has built a thriving learning ecosystem that aligns learning with business goals. Her strategy of embedding dedicated learning partners within business units ensures that training programs are not only relevant but integral to the organization's success.

Under her leadership, CGI has achieved extraordinary milestones in Artificial Intelligence literacy programs, including a 98% adoption rate and over 55,000 hours in a single year. She mentions, "These numbers aren't just about meeting metrics and KPIs — it's about the lives we've touched and the careers we've advanced."

Programs like the Expert Excellence Program (EEP), which consists of tech and industry-focused mentoring for over 650+ managers, fostering team connections, underscore her dedication to fostering a culture of continuous learning. The Leadership Masterclass, Executive Presence, and the Leadership Transformation Journey are among the key initiatives designed by her to drive leadership development and transformation.

Her leadership reflects her ability to blend technical and behavioral learning into a unified framework that drives growth across all levels of an organization. Drawing inspiration from CGI's culture of innovation and inclusivity, she developed a structured Learning Framework to nurture talent at every career stage.

From equipping freshers with in-demand skills to fostering leadership among senior executives, this framework provides tailored learning paths aligned with both technical and behavioral competencies. Collaborating with strategic partners like Techademy, Srilata ensures that CGI's professionals are updated in a rapidly evolving industry. "Our programs aren't just about upskilling—they're



Srilata Kolachana

Director of Learning & Development - CGI, APAC

Srilata Kolachana's journey in Learning and Development (L&D) is a story of passion, resilience, and purpose. As a child, she was fascinated by the power of education that can help transform lives, a belief that stayed with her as she pursued a double master's degree in marketing and finance.

Her early career as a lecturer for postgraduates laid the groundwork for her transition into the corporate world, where she discovered her true calling. Today, as the Director of Learning and Development for Asia Pacific at CGI, she brings this lifelong passion to her leadership.

about preparing for the future," she explains.

How CGI Empowered Her Leadership

CGI's culture has been instrumental in shaping

Srilata's leadership journey. The organization's emphasis on empowering employees, fostering inclusivity, and embracing innovation support her vision. With access to advanced technologies and partnerships, she has implemented programs that benefit employees and the business alike, focusing on a symbiotic relationship between leadership and organizational support.

Championing Inclusivity and Empowerment

Srilata's story is also one of advocacy and mentorship. She champions Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) through various programs which empower women to excel in leadership and technical roles. She also mentors women rejoining the workforce after a career break, reflecting her commitment to empowerment and equal opportunities. For Srilata, inclusion is not just a goal—it is the essence of leadership.

Driving Innovation in Learning

From developing business intelligence dashboards to automating learning assessments—all while training her team on AI—Srilata has consistently brought forward innovative solutions that enhance learning outcomes. "I believe that staying ahead of technological trends is essential for any L&D professional," she explains. These efforts not only enhance learning outcomes but also position CGI as a leader in leveraging technology for employee development.

Under Srilata Kolachana's leadership, CGI has transformed the utilization of its learning platform, CGI Academia. By introducing structured learning journeys in Academia with instructor-led interventions, she drove record footfall levels of 93% with a significant increase of 11% compared to previous fiscal year.

This initiative enhanced pre-session preparation, set a new learning standard, and made offerings accessible anytime, anywhere, leveraging AI-driven interventions to expand reach and impact.

A Legacy of Impact

Srilata's journey is a testament to the power of intentionality and passion. From mentoring others to leading innovative programs, she has touched countless lives, creating ripples of change that extend far beyond CGI. Her ability to inspire, empower, and innovate makes her a true trailblazer in the field of Learning and Development.

CGI's achievements in the L&D space are deeply intertwined with Srilata's visionary leadership. Together, they tell a story of purpose, partnership, and progress, showcasing what is possible when individual passion meets organizational excellence.